

Quote-to-Booking Agent for Vortmar Freight

Prepared for Vortmar Freight & Logistics · March 2, 2026

Client	Vortmar Freight & Logistics (mid-size forwarder, Antwerp + Hamburg)
Engagement	Phased build — pilot lane first, expand on proven results
Timeline	8 weeks to pilot lane go-live
Investment	€11,400 (pilot build) + €890/month (managed)
Scope	Inbound RFQ email → quote draft → booking confirmation

Executive Summary

Vortmar receives roughly 90 RFQ emails per day across the Antwerp–Felixstowe and Hamburg–Gdynia lanes. Your team currently spends 3 to 4 minutes per quote on data extraction alone — pulling container size, commodity, hazmat status, pickup window, and INCO term out of unstructured email text — before any rate work begins. This proposal builds an agent that handles that extraction step, cross-references your rate sheet, drafts the quote, and queues it for a human dispatcher's review. We estimate a 60–70% reduction in time-to-first-quote on the pilot lane.

Understanding of Requirements

From two discovery sessions with your operations lead and three ride-along observations of dispatcher workflows, we identified the specific friction points: customers send RFQs in five distinct formats including PDF attachments and forwarded carrier emails; your team uses Excel-based rate sheets that update twice weekly; and your TMS (CargoWise) does not have an open API for new quote creation, so quotes must be drafted and copied into the TMS by a human.

Critically, you also told us what you do *not* want: an agent that books shipments autonomously. Every quote and every booking must be reviewed and accepted by a dispatcher. The role of the agent is to do the preparation work, never to commit Vortmar to a carrier or a price.

Proposed Solution

RFQ extraction layer

An email watcher on a dedicated mailbox (rfq@vortmar.com) parses every incoming message, including PDF attachments, into a structured quote request: origin, destination, container type, commodity, hazmat (UN number if present), gross weight, requested pickup window, INCO term, special handling notes. Confidence scores per field — anything below 0.8 confidence is flagged for human review rather than silently filled.

Rate-sheet retrieval and quote drafting

The agent consults your current rate sheet (we ingest the Excel file twice weekly, on the same cadence your team updates it) and drafts a quote with line items, surcharges, and a validity window. Any rate that requires a special arrangement — overweight, out-of-gauge, hazmat surcharges — triggers a 'needs human pricing' flag rather than a guess.

Dispatcher review interface

Drafted quotes appear in a queue interface for your dispatchers. Each quote shows the original email, the extracted fields, the draft quote, and any flags. The dispatcher accepts, edits, or rejects. Accepted quotes are sent to the customer and logged for manual entry into CargoWise — until your TMS API access changes, we do not bypass that step.

Phasing

Phase 1 — Pilot lane (this engagement)

Antwerp–Felixstowe lane only. One mailbox, one rate sheet, two dispatchers piloting. Eight-week build. Success metric: median time-to-first-quote drops from 14 minutes to under 6 minutes across 100 quote events.

Phase 2 — Expansion (separate engagement)

Add Hamburg–Gdynia lane and air freight desk. Estimated 4 weeks. We do not propose this scope until the pilot lane has met its success metric and run for at least 30 days.

Project Timeline

Week	Milestone	Deliverable
1–2	Discovery & corpus	100 historical RFQs labelled, schema agreed
3–4	Extraction layer	Structured extraction at >0.8 confidence on 85% of test set
5	Rate-sheet integration	Drafts produced for 50 historical RFQs, dispatcher review
6	Review interface	Internal tool live in staging
7	Pilot week	Two dispatchers using the system on live RFQs
8	Tuning & handover	Runbook, monitoring, weekly review cadence

Pricing

Component	Cost
Discovery, corpus labelling, schema design	€2,200
Extraction layer (email + PDF parsing, Claude tool calls)	€4,000
Rate-sheet integration and quote drafting	€2,800
Dispatcher review interface	€1,800
Pilot week, tuning, runbook	€600
Managed retainer (volume-tiered, 6-month minimum)	€890 / month

Relevant Experience

Logistics is a focus area for Nexrai Labs. We have built one comparable extraction-and-drafting system for a customs brokerage in Rotterdam (HS-code suggestion + duty draft, in production for 11 months) and a smaller one for a domestic carrier in Lyon (quote-to-confirmation for parcel movements). Both clients are reachable as references and the Rotterdam team has agreed to a 30-minute reference call if helpful.

Why Nexrai Labs

- We treat agentic systems as drafting tools, not autonomous decision makers — every quote and every booking is human-reviewed.
- Confidence-scored extraction with explicit flags, never silent fill-ins.
- Phased commercial structure — you do not pay for expansion lanes until the pilot lane has proven itself.
- Logistics-domain experience with Rotterdam and Lyon references available.

Appendix

Architecture diagram, schema for the extraction layer, sample dispatcher interface mockups, and a confidentiality agreement template are included in the shared folder.